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At the end of each year, my wife and I sit down and plan our next year's finances. We create a forward-looking annual Conscious Spending Plan where we work out how much we'll allocate for gifts and donations. For example, we might decide that each gift is going to be \$100. We know how many friends and family members we'll give gifts to, so we bake this into our plan for the year. (And we make sure to add a little extra—usually 10 to 15 percent—for unexpected gifts as well.) We do the same for charity, travel, and other major areas of spending. This process takes it from a “desire”—to be generous, charitable, to travel more—to a real plan.